

VIVA

Every assessment should provide evidence of learning that the student could explain and defend.

UNDERPINNED BY INTEGRITY, HONESTY AND TRANSPARENCY

VIVA asks whether an assessment provides credible and proportionate evidence of the student's own learning, judgement and responsibility. It supports, and does not replace, current University policy, local guidance or approval processes.

ASSESSMENT-DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Design assessments that produce verifiable judgement.

The central question is not simply "Did AI write this?" but whether the assessment provides credible evidence that the student can reach a reasoned conclusion, and explain, defend and apply it. VIVA is the practical framework for designing that evidence.

V

Valid

The assessment produces valid evidence of the intended learning.

Start with what students should know, do or judge. Set AI permissions so assistance supports learning without replacing the capability being assessed.

I

Inclusive

The assessment is equitable, accessible and proportionate.

Provide equal baseline access to permitted tools. Consider disability, language, cost, digital confidence, reasonable adjustments, workload and any oral or process evidence.

V

Visible

The student's own reasoning and decisions can be seen.

Use application, drafts, annotations, source verification, process records, reflective explanation or structured questioning. Visibility does not require a viva voce.

A

Accountable

Permissions, responsibilities and AI use are explicit.

State what is permitted, required and prohibited. Specify any declaration. Students remain responsible for accuracy, evidence, sources, ethics and the final submission.

Could the student explain and defend the work?

AI may assist in producing an answer. Assessment should nevertheless provide proportionate evidence of the student's own understanding and judgement under the conditions established for the task. Look for evidence through critique, defence, application, and reflection on decision-making. If that evidence is weak, strengthen the task or what students must show.

Triangulate evidence where necessary

Where AI could materially obscure the capability being assessed, draw on more than one proportionate source of evidence, such as the submitted work together with staged drafts, explanation or dialogue. Triangulation strengthens the judgement; no single component proves authorship.

Important qualification

VIVA does not mean every assessment needs a viva voce. It means every assessment should provide credible and proportionate evidence of the student's own learning, judgement and responsibility. Verifiable judgement is the goal; VIVA is one practical framework for designing it.

Grounding

Aligned with the University of Oxford's current policy on AI use in summative assessment. Users should also follow applicable divisional, departmental, programme and reasonable-adjustment requirements.



Full interactive toolkit

<https://gitcausuk.github.io/aitoolkit/#home>